



### A jewel in sound

Find out about the odd story of how Brian Eno ended up composing the Windows 95 startup sound. <https://digit.in/jan20-39>



### History of MGM lions

From the photos to moving logos, a comprehensive history of the MGM lions. <https://digit.in/jan20-40>

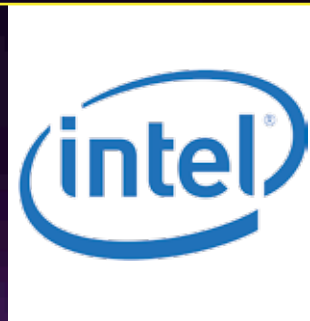
#### PLAYSTATION

The PlayStation startup sound was long, complex, layered and instantly forgettable. The PS2 sound has been extensively meme-fied because of how similar it is to the scream from Kirin J Callinan's Big Enough. The PS3 used a weird three part robot voice, which has also been made fun of. Learning from all this, the PS4 had a calming and neutral startup sound.



#### INTEL BONG

The composer, Walter Werzowa for the Intel Inside bong was initially hired to animate the "swirl" logo of the early 90s, and came up with the accompanying jingle while repeating the words "intel inside". The jingle had to convey reliability, trust and innovation, within a span of five notes. According to some estimates, the sound is heard every five minutes somewhere in the world.



#### SONY DING

The PlayStation experiments does not mean that Sony does not know to make really good audio logos. The Sony ding is one of the most simplest and recognisable sounds around, and consists of a single G sharp note. At times the sound is not used at all, and allows a smooth transition into say, the logo of another studio, or the background score of a movie.



#### WINDOWS STARTUP

Microsoft went up to Brian Eno and gave him a long list of adjectives to make a startup sound, including optimistic, futuristic, inspirational and emotional, with a constraint of 3.5 seconds. Eno came up with the sound after 83 iterations. In an interview with BBC, Eno admitted that he had used a Mac to make the Windows 95 startup sound, and did not enjoy using PCs.



#### NETFLIX

Early this year, Netflix started using a zooming red intro instead of the logo against a white background. The company spent two years on the animation. What stayed the same however, was the intro sound. Unlike most of the audio logos on this list, Netflix uses beats in the audio logo. There are just two beats, but it still manages to be short, impactful and recognisable.



#### NINTENDO SWITCH CLICK

This is easily the newest addition to the list, but Nintendo has a long history of making instantly recognisable sounds. One of the other famous audio marks by the company is the sound that Mario makes when a coin is picked up. The really crazy thing about this sound is that it is actually the sound that the JoyCon controllers make when docked with the Switch.

